providing management courses, and top 15 executive management programmes.

FULL-TIME MBA/ PGDM RANKING:

A comprehensive list of B-schools offering full-time classroom management programmes (PGDM/ MBA), established at least five years ago and with a minimum of three graduated batches till academic year ending in 2022, were considered for the rankings. An objective questionnaire was fine-tuned to obtain the latest relevant information—current year data—from the institutes on 127 attributes to give stakeholders more realistic, updated and accurate information. More than 2,500 B-schools across India, fulfilling the qualification criteria for participation, were contacted and 273 of them responded within the deadline. One entry was not considered as the institute failed to meet the eligibility criteria.

After receiving the objective data, four processes—data cleaning logical checks, validation, back-checks and audits—were conducted. In the first stage, every aspect of the details provided by the B-schools was carefully examined through available information and database available with MDRA. In the second stage, verification and audits of the participating B-schools were conducted by MDRA researchers to ensure accuracy and correctness of the data submitted. Nearly 15 per cent of the participating B-schools were physically visited by the research team to verify the authenticity of the data. In the past 11 years, MDRA researchers have visited close to 650 campuses to verify various information provided by participating institutes. After cross-checking the data with the original documents/ infrastructure, some irregularities were corrected.

The five key parameters of evaluation were Learning Experience, Living Experience, Selection Process, Placement Performance and Future Orientation. The scores of these parameters were then summed up to get the total objective score for each institute.

PARAMETERS AND WEIGHTAGE

Learning experience: **250**

Placement performance: **250**

Future orientation: **200**

Selection process, governance and establishment: **150**

Living experience: **150**

Total: **1,000**

The final rank was assigned to the B-schools based on objective data after various levels of cross-validation through multiple sources and also physical audits.

ONE-YEAR MANAGEMENT COURSE RANKING:

It has been prepared based on objective data and perception survey of management programmes (12-18 months) for working executives. These are full-time, in-classroom programmes with tough admission criteria such as work experience and entrance test scores that require rigorous commitment from the students. The objective parameters cover aspects such as admission attractiveness, pedagogy and infrastructure, career growth, return on investment and brand appeal. In this first year of the ranking, a total of nine institutes submitted the objective data of their executive management programme within the timeline. However, some institutes, which did not submit data, were ranked based on publicly available data. Simultaneously, a perception survey was conducted among stakeholders, including faculty, students, recruiters and alumni. In all, 190 relevant respondents, including 64 students, 43 faculty, 33 alumni and 50 recruiters, participated in the perception survey. Final scores were given by adding both objective and perception scores in equal proportion.

EXECUTIVE PROGRAMME RANKING:

Only those general management programmes from top institutes that are rigorously operated and have been there for quite some time were evaluated for this ranking. These programmes were also ranked based on the objective data collected through secondary research. Parameters such as programme fees, institute's reputation, course sustainability, number of interactions per week, eligibility criteria, number of online/offline classes and pedagogy were the main considerations.

A large team comprising researchers, statisticians, econometricians and analysts worked on this project from December 2022 last year to June 2023. The MDRA core team was ably led by Abhishek Agrawal (executive director) and included Abnish Jha (project director), Vaibhav Gupta (assistant research manager), Aditya Srivastava (research executive), Poornima Shukla (assistant research executive), and also Manveer Singh (senior executive EDP). ■